

Enter the Planetary Project, a recorded effort to compile interviews from every planet in the solar system.

Before this tireless work began, the following hypotheses were constructed:

- Humans from colder planets are naturally less social.
- Children prefer living on gas giants.
- The mean height of Plutonians exceeds that of Uranians.

And sapients will not cease to be sapient, no matter how hard they try.

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Enter **Saturn**, the famed gas giant. Known for its beautiful rings of water and ice, Saturn has become an increasingly popular tourist spot over the years.

Samira (9), born and raised there, cared little about tourism.

“They can do whatever”, she explained emphatically.

Despite refusing to comment on geopolitical issues, she described a harrowing tale about her dog named Cupcake.

“Cupcake ran away last year. I was really sad, so I went looking. I kept walking and walking and walking, but Saturn is huge. After some time, I went all the way around.”

Reporters asked whether her parents accompanied her. As always, she refused to comment. Two lollipops were given as remuneration.

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Enter **Jupiter**, home of the endless storm. Filled with gas and liquid, it is a miracle that some tenacious thrill-seekers have made this planet their home.

Jason (35), an eligible bachelor, fielded some angry complaints about its 95 moons.

“Fell in love with this one chick, right, and her name wasAdrastea. I was like woah, that sounds Greek, until she told me about the moon business. Super weird stuff, super esoteric and spiritual, but I was okay with it, yeah.”

After ten months of dating,Adrastea accused him of seeing other moons. Because there were 94 suspects, most being rather hard to reach, she purportedly keyed his spacecraft instead of confirming her suspicions. This resulted in travel difficulties and a lengthy lawsuit.

“Anyway, still pissed as hell,” was a sentence that he asked to be included.

“If any other moons wanna hit me up, go ahead. I mean, I’m single now.”

Enter **Venus**; second closest planet to the sun, fiery ball of joy, and hotter than hot. A favourite of ice-dwelling humans.

Ailema (Amelia)— in accordance with Venus’ reverse spin— spoke backwards for the entire interview. All sentences have been combed and translated.

“Now, I don’t go out in those stupid suits. I just breathe it in, align my energies, manifest my truth. I’m really at peace with myself. No one else needs to understand.”

Rather proud of her new self-help book, ‘The Venus Mindset’, Ailema gave listeners some crucial advice;

“Don’t conform. Don’t be a sheep. If you’re a sheep, the lions will eat you and stomp all over you.”

Despite growing aggressive after interviewers asked if she had seen a sheep before (and why the pressure on Venus didn’t crush her suitless body), Ailema seemed kind enough. She also welcomed travellers to the planet, but stressed that they had to speak backwards.

“If they don’t speak right, I’ll look at them funny.”

Interviewers refrained from mentioning the irony in that.

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Enter **Neptune** and **Uranus**. These adjacent blue planets reside under a united dictatorship, and are thus barred from participating in foreign media. Uranus’ former representative, a man named B, attempted to find some sort of legal loophole. Unfortunately, he was assassinated 40 days after contacting the recording studio. His charges included treason and calling Uranus “***** (anus?)”. Rest in peace.

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Enter **Pluto**. Pluto was originally exempt from project recordings, but one of the planet’s ten residents, Geb, had much to say.

“They de-planetized us because we are strong. We are mighty, and we are a fucking force to be reckoned with!” Geb stated, waving his fist in the air.

According to his testimony, Plutonians had been protesting their demoted status since 2006.

“I hold that year close to my heart, actually; year my daughter was born. Her name’s Angelina, and she’ll be old enough for the picket line soon.”

Geb then offered a free tour of Pluto. He boasted that one could see the trash fires from twenty miles off. Unfortunately, due to various concerns, Planetary Project employees could not take him up on his offer.



Enter **Mercury**; every couple's preferred landing pad. Its numerous craters allow for parks, sidewalks, and houses built in traditional Space American fashion. Residents live peaceful lives and run homeowners' associations, greeting newcomers with baskets of bread, moon jam, and if you're lucky, pie.

"We love it here," Jeanine, mother of 27, explained in an interview with her husband;

"I just wish the Joneses weren't so crazy about fences."

The Joneses, also present for the interview, retorted,

"Their stupid dog doesn't respect our fence. It's absolutely nonsense! First of all, the HOA agreement explicitly stated no pets, but they got a free pass after Poundcake showed up out of nowhere. With a collar, too. We bet they stole him."

"We did *not*!"

"You did too."

"My wig, you bitch! Let go!"

Attempting to avoid further arguments, interviewers ended the recording early and separated both families. The Planetary Project concluded that taking folks from their craters was a recipe for disaster; a learning experience, at least?



Enter **Mars**. No fanfare, no description. By then, not much of note had come from the other planets and funding was running dry. Producers knew this supposed 'martian' would be their make or break moment.

Glorb, a self-identified alien from Mars, arrived in traditional garb. He wore green face paint and antennae, but this did not fool anyone—he was completely human.

"Gloop glab glab glob glub glurt," he said.

Born Joe Weng, Glorb emigrated to Mars as part of a failed launch program. His crewmates perished during the rough journey, and if it were not for his unfailing spirit, he might have suffered their fates. Days spent without food and water resulted in some sort of bizarre psychosis; once rescuers came down, he refused to leave and took to calling himself Glorb.

"Glorb Glab glep gleeb glat glur."

A language interpreter was later brought in. His words translated directly to,

"It's too late now. I refuse your sympathy."



Enter **Earth**. As the human species' motherland, Earth has always held a near and dear place in their hearts. Luscious forests, mountains stretching to the proverbial heavens, a globe created in loving care... It begs to ask why intergalactic immigration began.

Former astronaut Selkin Chappelle, chief executive officer of NASA from 2598 to 2610, provided his two cents on the topic.

"Don't get me wrong, space is fascinating. Ever since I was a child, I knew I wanted to explore the great wide beyond. But I might be growing old, because... Oh, never mind. The government has done a commendable job promoting intergalactic movement—I'll say that. A hundred or so years after this, who knows? They've already found twenty Earths just like ours. Aside from the, y'know, oddballs who stay in the solar system, we have dispersed exceptionally well."

Another quote: "Putting it into perspective, I can't sleep at night sometimes, thinking about... All these characters, these lives you've recorded. They're brought together by the Planetary Project, and that's important, whether you realise it or not. Almost feels like a family. We haven't changed, really; just come around."

Interviewers thanked him for his continued support.

"No, thank *you*. I hope Samira finds her dog some day."

Chappelle was kind and humble, with little to add about himself. His most valuable, quotable insights were far removed from any personal matters. In closing, he said;

"It is indeed a very mortal and very selfish desire to run."

That concluded Chappelle's interview.



Exit the Planetary Project, a recorded effort to compile interviews from every planet in the solar system. As a result of this tireless work, the following conclusions were reached:

- Pluto should be a planet.
- Genetically green Mars-dwellers do not exist.
- Money runs dry very quickly.
- Living off Earth makes one loopy, but living on Earth makes one sad.

And sapients do not cease to be sapient, no matter how hard they try.